

If you bought your home after 1999, your lender must terminate your PMI when you reach 20 percent equity, if you request it. Some businesses offer a service to help you get your PMI dropped, but don't waste your money. Just call your lender and ask if you're paying PMI and if so, when it can be canceled. Then be sure to call again when that time arrives. If you have an FHA or VA loan, PMI isn't required because the federal government has already agreed to protect the lender if you default on your loan.